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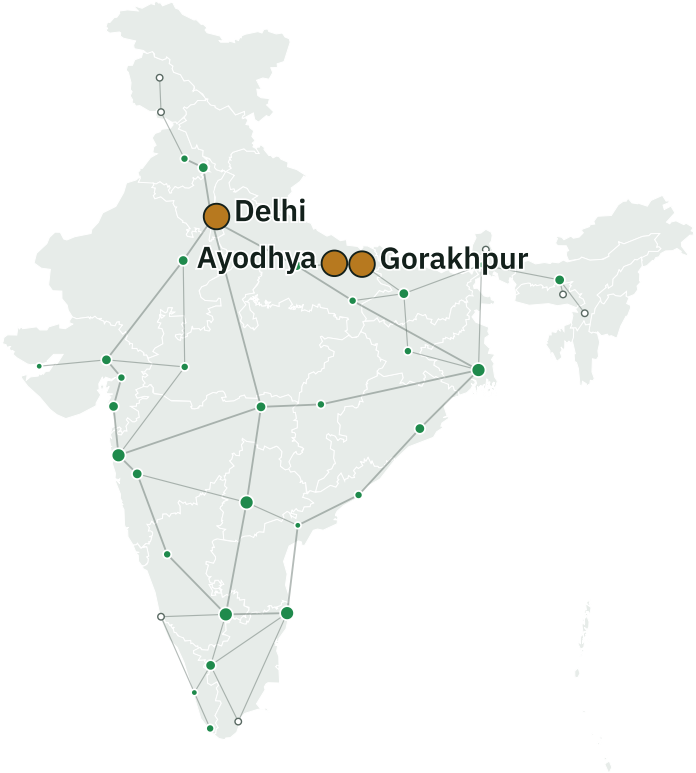
Delhi's pollution curbs take older diesel trucks off Diwali top-ups

● NETWORK: AMBER

DIWALI WEEK · 1 DAY TO DIWALI

For e-commerce, D2C and consumer-goods teams delivering orders and stocking shops through Diwali.

Delhi and its satellite towns moved to Stage III of their pollution plan on Friday evening, two days before Diwali[1]. So Delhi's own older diesel goods trucks stay off its roads unless they carry essentials. And round Ayodhya, the lamp festival keeps trucks off NH-27, the Lucknow–Gorakhpur highway, till Sunday night[2].



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for peak week: busy, but delivery promises hold
● AMBER something is slowing deliveries beyond normal peak
● RED deliveries largely stopped across a state or city, or a courier embargo on the route

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Sun 1 Nov** Delhi admits outside goods vehicles only if BS-VI, CNG, LNG or electric[3]
- **Until Thu 12 Nov** Pune's old-city markets take goods vehicles only at night
- **Sun 8 Nov** Kolkata keeps goods vehicles off its roads for Kali Puja
- **Mon 9 – Wed 11 Nov** Kolkata curbs goods vehicles for the immersions
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Gujarat's markets and transport shut till Labh Pancham

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+1*	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
AMBER	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN

* Likely impact (#days) on delivery promise up to Diwali within the region, specific to certain cities or pincodes, beyond what is expected for the season.

Delhi's older diesel goods trucks come off its roads before Diwali

North · Delhi, with Gurugram, Noida, Ghaziabad and Faridabad around it

AMBER · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) brought in Stage III of GRAP, Delhi-NCR's graded pollution action plan, on Friday as a precaution, after Thursday's air quality index read 382[1]. Under Stage III, Delhi-registered diesel goods trucks of BS-IV or older, the emission standard before 2020, stay off Delhi's roads unless they carry essential goods[4]. Moving cement, sand and bricks stops too. It adds to the BS-VI-only rule for goods vehicles from other states, in force since 1 November. How many of Delhi's own trucks are that old? Nobody has published a count, mind you.

- **Delhi** North · +1 day Gift packs, electronics and other non-essential stock on an older Delhi truck waits for a newer one. I'd expect some Saturday top-ups to slip past Diwali, and Monday's restart to run a day behind in the city.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Non-essential orders into Delhi pin codes may be held a day if they ride an older Delhi truck, so Tuesday is the safer promise than Monday, my estimate, unless the carrier confirms BS-VI trucks.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- Food and other essentials are exempt, so sweets and grocery top-ups still run; durables and gift packs booked on an older Delhi truck need a BS-VI one before Monday's restocking.

Ayodhya's lamp festival shuts NH-27 to trucks round the city till Sunday night

North · NH-27 from Lucknow through Ayodhya and Basti to Gorakhpur, and the Bihar trucks that use it

AMBER · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Deepotsav, Ayodhya's festival of lamps along the river on Diwali eve, is tonight. Police have kept trucks, light trucks and tractors out since midnight on Friday, sending them along 13 diversions until the crowds clear on Sunday[5]. Only essential services are exempt. Gorakhpur's police send trucks from Bihar to Lucknow, Kanpur and Delhi round by the Gorakhpur Link and Purvanchal expressways until 8 pm on Sunday[2].

- **Ayodhya, Basti and Ambedkar Nagar** North · +1 day Linehaul trucks into these towns' delivery hubs wait till the curb lifts. I'd expect parcels already on their way to miss Diwali and land on Monday, with vans already in town still delivering.
- **Bihar and Gorakhpur to Lucknow, round the expressways** North · +1 day The detour adds a few hours to every Bihar load bound for Lucknow and Delhi. I'd expect some to miss Lucknow's night departures on Saturday and Sunday, landing a day late in Delhi early next week.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Parcels for Ayodhya, Basti and Ambedkar Nagar pin codes still in the Lucknow or Gorakhpur hubs won't make Diwali; Monday is my estimate, and customers are better told today.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- Shop top-ups into Ayodhya can't go by truck till Sunday night, so anything that missed Friday's last load waits for Monday's restart.

SOURCES

1. The Statesman: GRAP-III restrictions enforced across NCR ahead of Diwali, 6 Nov
2. Dainik Bhaskar: Gorakhpur sends Bihar trucks round by the expressways for Ayodhya's Deepotsav, 6 Nov
3. ETV Bharat: Delhi turns away BS-IV vehicles for a second day, 2 Nov
4. CAQM's Stage III action plan, as issued when it last invoked Stage III (press release reprinted by Uttarakhand News Network), 16 Jan
5. Amar Ujala: heavy vehicles barred from Ayodhya for three days for Deepotsav, 4 Nov